
Disaster SEPs in CO, HI, MS, and TX

HealthSpring Medicare Advantage <salesupdates@mabrokers.healthspring.com>

Mon, Sep 14 at 9:03 AM

Reply-To: <salesupdates@healthspring.com>

To: <yperez@healthexps.com>



Disaster Special Election Periods (DST-SEPs)

DST-SEPs in Colorado, Hawaii, Mississippi, and Texas

This communication is an important announcement for those with clientele and business in the following states, commonwealths, and/or districts: **Colorado, Hawaii, Mississippi, and Texas.**

The counties, parishes, boroughs, tribes, cities, municipalities, and/or villages noted below are under a federal or state-designated Special Enrollment Period (SEP) due to an emergency/disaster (DST).

IMPORTANT NOTES:

- DST SEPs can only be used if the beneficiary is eligible for another election period at the time of the DST eligibility period and **has not** already made an election during that other valid election period due to the disaster or other emergency.
- **This email is a weekly reminder and does not include all active SEPs.** Please refer to our [Ongoing SEP tracker](#) in Producers' University (login required) for the most recent DST - SEP information (updated daily).

- Also, please review the DST-SEP guidelines at the bottom of this email or our [DST-SEP informational video](#)¹ for guidance on the proper and compliant application of FEMA and DST-SEPs.

Colorado

[Declaration information](#)¹ (New)

FEMA declaration: Wildfires, Flooding, and Mudslides

SEP incident dates: 06/27/2026 - 09/30/2026

This SEP declaration is effective: 06/27/2026 - 11/30/2026

Impacted counties for SEP purposes: Custer, Dolores, Ouray, and Pueblo Counties.

Hawaii

[Declaration information](#)¹ (Renewed)

PHE declaration: Severe Storms, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides

SEP incident dates: 03/10/2026 - 12/31/2026

This SEP declaration is effective: 03/10/2026 - 02/28/2027

Impacted counties for SEP purposes: All Counties.

Mississippi

[Declaration information](#)¹ (Amendment adds county in bold)

FEMA declaration: Tropical Storm Arhur

SEP incident dates: 06/18/2026 - 10/07/2026

This SEP declaration is effective: 06/18/2026 - 11/30/2026

Impacted counties for SEP purposes: Hancock, Harrison, Pearl River, **Perry**, and Stone Counties.

Texas

[Declaration information](#)¹ (Renewed)

State declaration: Fire Weather Conditions

SEP incident dates: 08/10/2025 - 08/31/2026

This SEP declaration is effective: 08/10/2025 - 10/31/2026

Impacted counties for SEP purposes: Armstrong, Bailey, Briscoe, Carson,

Castro, Cochran, Collingsworth, Crosby, Dallam, Deaf Smith, Dickens, Donley, Floyd, Garza, Gray, Hale, Hall, Hansford, Hartley, Hemphill, Hockley, Hutchinson, Kent, Lamb, Lipscomb, Lubbock, Lynn, Moore, Motley, Ochiltree, Oldham, Parmer, Potter, Randall, Roberts, Sherman, Swisher, Terry, Wheeler, and Yoakum Counties.

[Declaration information](#)¹ (New)

FEMA declaration: Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding

SEP incident dates: 07/12/2026 - 08/31/2027

This SEP declaration is effective: 07/12/2026 - 11/30/2027

Impacted counties for SEP purposes: Bandera, Crockett, Dimmit, Edwards, Frio, Gillespie, Kendall, Kerr, Kimble, Kinney, La Salle, Mason, Maverick, Menard, Real, Sutton, Uvalde, Val Verde, and Zavala Counties.

Important notices

Please note: A DST-SEP application is only valid while the SEP declaration is in effect. If an end date is not listed, please refer to our [Ongoing SEP tracker](#) in Producers' University (login required) for the most up-to-date information. Any SEP applications submitted outside of the SEP's declaration date will be rejected.

IMPORTANT – Please be aware that a DST SEP:

- does not mean that active marketing can occur.
- is only available for individuals that reside or resided at the start of the SEP eligibility period where a federal, state, or local government entity declared a disaster or other emergency.
- can only be used if the individual was eligible for another election period at the time of the DST eligibility period and did not make an election during that other valid election period due to the disaster or other emergency.
- does not mean that HealthSpring initiated waiving of authorization or referral requirements.
- does not extend waiving of prior authorizations, referrals, etc.

SEP for individuals affected by a government-entity declared disaster or

other emergency

42 CFR §§ 422.62(b)(18) and 423.38(c)(23)

Please review [this link](#)¹ to refer to the guidance from the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) on DST-SEPs.

Our DST application process

Two important details:

1. The date of the disaster is not required on any DST applications.
2. The missed election period is not required on most applications. See clarification below.

Keep in mind: Some missed election periods will still require you to input the missed election period AND the date of the missed election period on the application. Some examples include MOV (moving) or LEC (losing group coverage). The application will contain an "open" date field next to the SEP selections that still require a date to help you know when it is required.

For all applications, ensure that the following fields are completed:

- Select "SEP" in the *Select Enrollment Period* field.
- Enter code "DST" in the *SEP Code* field.
- If applicable, enter the date associated with the missed election period.
For example, a date is needed only if the missed SEP already required a date, such as moving, losing group coverage, losing or gaining Medicaid, etc. If the missed SEP or election period does not require a date, you do not need to include it. However, adding it may expedite the review process. (i.e., AEP, OEP, DEP, INT-SEP).

DST is not a standalone election period. If you have questions about DST eligibility, please review the [Election Period Booklet](#) in the Resource Center of Producers' University (login required).



We uphold compliance





Agent Resource Center (ARC)

866-442-7516

ARCMAPD@HealthSpring.com

Log in to [the broker portal](#) and visit Salesforce to use click-to-chat

7 a.m. to 6 p.m. CT, Monday – Friday

Spanish queue available

¹ You are leaving this website/app (“site”). The new site may be offered by a vendor or an independent third party. The site may also contain non-Medicare related information. Some sites may require you to agree to their terms of use and privacy policy.

HealthSpring products and services are provided exclusively by or through operating subsidiaries of Health Care Service Corporation, a Mutual Legal Reserve Company.

[300 East Randolph Street | Chicago, IL 60601 US](#)

© 2026 Health Care Service Corporation. All Rights Reserved.

[Unsubscribe](#) | [Update Profile](#) | [Constant Contact Data Notice](#)

[Privacy](#) | [Terms of Use](#)

View in [Web Browser](#)